

There are even more filters than the ones listed above, and yet more can be added by installing packages that provide filters. A package with some extra tags and filters called ‘django.contrib.humanize’ is included with Django. It has useful filters such as ‘intcomma’ that add commas into a long number, and ‘intword’ that converts a number like 2400000 to the string ‘2.4 million’.

It is also possible to chain multiple filters together in which case they will be applied in the order that they are listed.

Extending Templates

One of the most powerful aspects of Django templates is something we haven’t covered till now at all, and that is the ability to extend one template from another, and the ability to include bits from other template files. Templates support a form of inheritance that significantly reduces the amount of code you need to repeat.

The way template inheritance / extension works in the Django template language is that first create a base template that has the HTML framework of your website. This base template will probably have a basic HTML file skeleton with the root ‘html’ tag, and the ‘head’, ‘title’ and ‘body’ tags. You might also include any scripts and stylesheets that are applicable throughout your website. If you want you can even fill in some content, such as a site menu, a site header and footer, sidebars etc.

In this base page you also include special Django template elements called ‘blocks’ that serve as points of extension. These blocks, (and only these blocks) can be then overridden by any child templates. Child templates need not override all the blocks, and any blocks they don’t override will show the default content defined by the base template.

Let’s look at an example of a base template (site_base.html):

```

• <!DOCTYPE html>
• <html lang="en">
• <head>
•   <title>
•     {% block title %}My CMS{% endblock %}
•   </title>
• </head>
• <body>
• <aside id="sidebar">
•   {% block sidebar %}
•     <menu>

```